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## ATL SOUL: THE VELVET LaRUE STORY

A BET / Lifetime Original Movie Event

Genre: Soul-Music Biopic / Social-Issue Thriller

Format: 90-Minute Movie of the Week (MOW)

Tone: Dreamgirls meets Judas and the Black Messiah — equal parts glitter and grit.

Setting: Atlanta, 1970–1979

Created by: Kelly R. Tenney

Production Company: NCCA Entertainment

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## LOGLINE

1979, Atlanta. A drug-addicted soul singer, betrayed by her label and her city, hijacks the rooftop of the South's tallest hotel, broadcasting her stolen music live and baptizing a segregated pool in revolution, reclaiming her voice and rewriting history.

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## THE PITCH

A fever-drenched, music-driven odyssey through the neon-drenched streets of 1970s Atlanta. Velvet LaRue rises from the gospel-soaked Chitlin' Circuit to Soul Train fame, only to be exploited, erased, and discarded by the very machine she built. Now clean, broken, and dangerous, she takes her final shot at glory not in a studio but from 70 stories up, turning a segregated rooftop into a stage, a baptism, and a revolution.

With cinéma vérité realism clashing against surreal musical performance, ATL Soul blends historical injustice with glittering spectacle. It's Cadillac Records with gasoline. Ma Rainey with a riot. And Velvet? She's our Southern-fried Joan of Arc, with gold hoops, a cracked voice, and something to prove.

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## WHY IT HITS NOW

- Timely & Timeless: Black women reclaiming stolen work (see: Taylor Swift, Megan Thee Stallion)
  - Spectacle: A rooftop concert becomes a cinematic riot of voice, faith, and fury
  - Soundtrack-Driven: 8 original soul songs + remixes, ripe for a full album rollout
  - Star Vehicle: A meaty, award-worthy lead role for a powerhouse actress-singer
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## TAGLINE

If Dreamgirls and When They See Us had a baby, and that baby was raised by Prince in 1979 Atlanta.

